Weekend Getaway: Yangshuo (2 Days / 1 Night)

Why Yangshuo?
Nestled among dreamlike karst mountains and the serene Li River, Yangshuo offers tranquility, stunning scenery, and gentle adventure -- all just a short flight + bus ride from Shanghai. Perfect for recharging without rushing.

Itinerary Overview

Day 0 (Friday Evening) -- Fly & Settle
- 18:00 Depart Shanghai Pudong/Hongqiao (e.g., HO1125, dep. 18:05 -> arrives Guilin 20:35)
- 21:15 Bus or private transfer from Guilin Liangjiang Airport -> Yangshuo (~1 hr, CNY 30-120)
- 22:30 Check in at your guesthouse (recommended: Yangshuo Mountain Retreat -- eco-friendly, riverside, great breakfast)
- Dinner: Try local beer fish (fish cooked in local rice wine) at West Street food stalls.

Day 1 (Saturday) -- Mountains, River & Culture
- 07:30 Breakfast at retreat
- 08:30 Rent e-bikes (CNY 30/day) -> ride to Yulong River (20 min)
- 09:30-11:30 Bamboo rafting on Yulong River (calm, scenic, iconic -- CNY 150/person)
- 12:00 Lunch at Chef's Table (farm-to-table, riverside terrace)
- 14:00 Explore Moon Hill (easy 20-min climb -> panoramic views; entrance CNY 30)
- 16:30 Return to town -> stroll West Street (craft shops, cafes, street performers)
- 19:30 Dinner at Green Tea Restaurant (authentic Guilin cuisine)

Day 2 (Sunday) -- Serenity & Departure
- 08:00 Breakfast + pack
- 09:00 Short hike to Xianggong Hill (best sunrise/sunset viewpoint -- optional early start)
- 10:30 Visit Blessing Cave (limestone cave with stalactites, CNY 60)
- 12:00 Brunch at No.1 Cafe (great coffee & banana pancakes)
- 13:30 Transfer to Guilin airport (arrive by 15:30 for 17:00+ flight back to Shanghai)

Accommodation Picks
- Budget: Jianguo Hostel (CNY 120-180/night, central, social vibe)
- Mid-range: Yangshuo Mountain Retreat (CNY 380-580/night, bamboo cottages, pool, yoga)
- Luxury: Banyan Tree Yangshuo (CNY 1200+/night, private villas, spa, river views)

Pro Tips
- Best photo spot: Xianggong Hill at golden hour (sunrise/sunset)
- Bike rental tip: E-bikes handle hills easily -- avoid standard bikes unless very fit
- Must-try: Beer fish, sticky rice in bamboo tube, osmanthus cake
- Book rafting & cave online in advance via WeChat mini-program "Yangshuo Travel" to skip lines
- Best weather: March-May & September-November (cool, clear, fewer crowds)

Yangshuo fits perfectly into a weekend: no jet lag, minimal transit stress, maximum soul recharge.